

**Peculiar chat app**

Die With Me allows users who have less than 5% of battery to enter a chat room and converse. <http://digit.in/DWMeApp>

**Video referee for World Cup 2018**

The International Football Association Board (IFAB) gave Video Assistant Referee the nod for Russia 2018. <http://digit.in/VARWC2018>

The Accessibility Question

Startups in India are bringing long-awaited accessibility to the disabled

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here are several statistics that speak of the severity of disabilities around the world. Rather

than looking at the total percentage of the world population that is disabled, when one looks at the numbers that show the impact of the same, it paints a more revealing picture. For instance, almost 30% of children in the age group of 5-19 years have never attended an educational institution according to the 2011 Census. Among the disabled, a large portion (33%. Source: Disabled persons in India 2016 report from Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation) is formed by people in the age group of 10-29 years old - which goes to show that disability is not something that is just to be associated with old age. It affects the learners, the bread earners the most - the people who are depended upon the most by an average Indian family. The same 2011 Census shows that only 1/3rd of the disabled population is employed.

Additionally, no statistic is required to understand that it is significantly harder for a disabled person to work at an average workplace, provided they can even get the job first. There is an



Some of the options from Rise Legs

urgent need to bridge the gap in India, where as much as three crore citizens could be specially-abled, according to the same census, while disability rights activists and academicians working on disability issues say that these numbers are a very small percentage of the actual numbers. Some startups have taken up the responsibility to bring about the much needed change, and they're achieving some amazing results.

RISE LEGS

One of the biggest hindrances when it comes to most cost-effective prosthetics for the disabled is the weight, as well as the flexibility. On the other hand, to avail the lighter, more flexible alternatives, often the people in need have to pay a huge price. Bangalore-

based startup Rise Legs took an approach that found the middle ground by using cane.

Cane is typically used to build household furniture and is flexible as compared to many other types of wooden materials. During a vacation in India, founder Arun Cherian had the idea to use it for prosthetics. He got the desired mold made by local artisans and tested at IISc, Bengaluru. One thing led to another and more than a year later, Rise Legs is providing cheaper, lighter prosthetics that are not only far more affordable than imported alternatives, but also useful enough to actually help people regain natural capabilities much faster.

They can also build the legs to be customised to a person's requirements. For instance, a person might be inter-